

The proverbs are in bold print while their meanings follow immediately

1) **A bad excuse is better than none.**= Always give an excuse, even if it's a poor one.

2) **A bad penny always turns up.** = An unwanted or disreputable person constantly comes back.

3) **A bad tree does not yield good apples.** = A bad parent does not raise good children.

4) **A bad workman blames his tools.** =Blaming the tools for bad workmanship is an excuse for lack of skill.

5) **A barking dog seldom bites.**= Someone who constantly makes threats rarely carries them out.

6) **A bird in hand is worth two in a bush.**= It is better to keep what you have rather than to risk losing it by searching for something better.

7) **A broken friendship may be soldered but will never be sound.**= Friendships can be rebuilt after a dispute but will never be as strong as before.

8) **A burden of one's own choice is not felt.**= Something difficult seems easier when it is done voluntarily.

9) **A burnt child dreads the fire.** =A bad experience will make people stay away from certain things.

10) **A cat has nine lives.** =1) Cats can survive many accidents because they land on their feet without injury. 2) Nine lives = 3 years to play, 3 years to stray, 3 years to stay.

11) **A chain is no stronger than its weakest link.** = The strength of a group depends on each individual member.

12) **A change is as good as a rest.**= A change in routine is often as refreshing as a break or a holiday.

13) **A constant guest is never welcome.** = If you come to visit too often, your host will be less pleased to see you.

14) **A danger foreseen is half avoided.** =If you are prepared to face a problem or difficulty, it will be easier to deal with.

15) **A dry March, a wet April and a cool May fill barn and cellar and bring much hay.** = Harvest predictions are made according to the weather.

16) **A fault confessed is half redressed.** =Confession is the beginning of forgiveness.

17) **A flower blooms more than once.** = If you miss an occasion, you can avail yourself of it another time.

18) **A fool and his money are (soon) easily parted.** = A foolish person usually spends money carelessly.

19) **A fool at forty is a fool forever.**= If a person hasn't matured by the age of 40, they never will.

20) **A friend in need is a friend indeed.** = Someone who helps you when you are in trouble is a real friend.

21) **A friend to all is a friend to none.**= Someone who is a friend to everyone makes none of them feel special.

22) **A friend's eye is a good mirror.**= A real friend will tell you the truth.

23) **A good example is the best sermon.**= Giving a good example is better than giving advice.

24) **A good beginning makes a good end.**= If a task is carefully planned, there's a better chance that it will be well done.

25) **A good conscience is a soft pillow.** = You sleep well when you have nothing to be guilty about.

26) **A guilty conscience needs no accuser.**= If you know that you have done something wrong, you don't need anyone to tell you that you're guilty.

27) **A hungry belly has no ears.**= A hungry person is totally concentrated on their need for food and nothing else interests them.

28) **A hungry wolf is fixed to no place.** =A desperate person will go from place to place when they need to satisfy their needs.

29) **A leopard cannot change its spots.**= It is impossible for a bad or unpleasant person to become good or pleasant.

30) **A lie begets a lie.** =Telling one lie will lead you to tell another one.

31) **A little fire is quickly trodden out.**= If you deal with a minor problem quickly, it will not become a major issue.

32) **A loaded wagon makes no noise.** =Really wealthy people do not talk about money.

33) **A loveless life is living death.**= Without affection, life is difficult.

34) **A man can die but once.**= If death comes now, you will not have to experience it later.

35) **A man is as old as he feels himself to be.**= Your age doesn't matter as long as you are fit and healthy.

36) **A man is known by the company he keeps.** =A person's character is judged by the type of people with whom they spend their time.

37) **A monkey in silk is a monkey no less.**= No matter how someone dresses, it's the same person underneath.

38) **A new broom sweeps clean.**= A newly-appointed person often makes changes quickly .

39) **A problem shared is a problem halved.**= It is easier to deal with a problem when you discuss it with someone.

40) **A rising tide lifts all boats.**= Refers to something that will be helpful to all.

41) **A rolling stone gathers no moss**= If a person keeps moving from place to place, they gain neither friends nor possessions. Another interpretation is that, by moving often, one avoids being tied down!

42) **A rotten apple spoils the barrel.**= A dishonest or immoral person can have a bad influence on a group.

43) **A smooth sea never made a skilled mariner.**= Overcoming adversity leads to competence.

44) **A stitch in time saves nine.**= If you deal with a problem at an early stage you will save time and prevent it from getting worse.

45) **A stumble may prevent a fall.** =Correcting a small mistake may help you to avoid making a bigger one.

46) **A swallow does not make the summer.**= One good event does not mean that everything is alright.

47) **A watched pot never boils.**= If you wait anxiously for something to happen, it seems to take a long time.

48) **A young idler, an old beggar.**= If you don't work, you won't have any money when you're old.

49) **Absence makes the heart grow fonder.** =When you are away from someone you love, you love them even more.

50) **Accidents will happen.**= Some unfortunate events must be accepted as inevitable.

51) **Actions speak louder than words.**= What a person actually does is more important than what they say they will do.

52) **Adversity makes strange bedfellows.** =People of all origins who share the same misfortune are drawn together.

53) **Advice is cheap.**= It doesn't cost anything to offer advice.

54) **Advice is least heeded when most needed.**= When a problem is serious, people often do not follow the advice given.

55) **Advisers run no risks.** =It's easier to give advice than to act.

56) **After dinner rest a while, after supper walk a while.**= Dinner is called 'lunch' nowadays, and supper has become 'dinner'.

57) **All cats are grey in the dark.** =People are undistinguished until they have made a name for themselves.

58) **All covet, all lose** =If you try to obtain everything, you risk losing everything.

59) **All days are short to industry and long to idleness.**= Time goes by slowly when you have nothing to do.

60) **All good things come to those who wait.**= If you are patient you will be rewarded.

61) **All that glitters is not gold.**= Appearances can be deceptive.

62) **All is fair in love and war.**= Things that are done in love or war can often be excused.

63) **All's well that ends well.**= There is a solution to everything even if there are doubts.

64) **All roads lead to Rome**= There are many different ways to reach an objective.

65) **All things grow with time – except grief.** =As time goes by, grief subsides little by little.

66) **All things are difficult before they are easy.** =With practice everything becomes easier.

67) **All work and no play makes Jack a dull boy.** =Everybody needs a certain amount of relaxation. It is not good to work all the time.

68) **An apple a day keeps the doctor away.**= Eating an apple every day can help to keep you healthy. Other interpretation: A small preventive treatment wards off serious problems.

69) **An empty purse frightens away friends.** =When one's financial situation deteriorates, friends tend to disappear.

70) **An Englishman's home is his castle**= An Englishman's home is a place where he feels safe, enjoys privacy and can do as he wishes.

71) **An idle brain is the devil's workshop.** =When you are busy working, you avoid temptation.

72) **An onion a day keeps everyone away.**= A humoristic version of "an apple a day..."

73) **An ounce of discretion is worth a pound of wit.**= It is better to be cautious and discreet than to try to be funny.

74) **An ounce of prevention is worth a pound of cure.**= It is easier to prevent something from happening than to repair the damage or cure the disease later.

75) **Anger is the one thing made better by delay.**= When you are angry, it is best not to speak or act immediately.

76) **Any time means no time.**= If the date of an event remains vague, it will never happen.

77) **April showers bring May flowers.**= Something bad or unpleasant today may bring good things in the future.

78) **As you sow, so shall you reap.**= You have to accept the consequences of your actions.

79) **Ask me no questions, I'll tell you no lies.**= There are subjects one would rather not discuss.

80) **Bad news travels fast.**= People tend to circulate bad news very quickly (accidents, illness, etc.).

81) **(A) bad tree does not yield good apples.**= A bad parent does not raise good children.

82) **(A) bad workman blames his tools.**= Blaming tools for bad workmanship is an excuse for lack of skill.

83) **Beauty is only skin deep.**= A person's character is more important than their appearance.

84) **Beauty is in the eye of the beholder.**= Different people have different tastes.

85) **Beauty is the wisdom of women. Wisdom is the beauty of men. Be swift to hear, slow to speak.**= Listen carefully before speaking.

88) **Better an egg today than a hen tomorrow.**= It is preferable to have something sure now than the possibility of something better later.

89) **Better be alone than in bad company.**= Be careful in the choice of the people you associate with.

90) **Better be the head of a dog than the tail of a lion.**= It's better to be the leader of a small group than a subordinate in a bigger one.

91) **Better flatter a fool than fight him.**= It's better to avoid disputes with stupid people.

92) **Better to drink the milk than to eat the cow.**= Be careful not to destroy the source of your income or welfare.

93) **Better the devil you know than the devil you don't know.**= It's better to deal with someone difficult but familiar than change and risk dealing with somebody worse.

94) **Better late than never.**= It's better to do something, even if it's late, than not do it at all.

95) **Better lose the saddle than the horse.**= It's better to stop and accept a small loss than continue and risk losing everything.

96) **Better safe than sorry.**= It's better to be too careful than to be careless and regret it later.

97) **Better be untaught than ill-taught.**= It's better not to be taught at all than to be taught badly.

98) **Beware of Greeks bearing gifts.**= Don't trust your enemies.

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